

موضوعاتی انتخاب — شعر سے شعور تک

URDU FOR POETRY LOVERS

VOLUME 7 • A THEMATIC ANTHOLOGY

*Eight worlds of feeling • sixteen close readings • forty living idioms
a bridge from translation to independent poetic understanding*

Prepared for

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From Vocabulary to a Poetic Mind

The earlier volumes gave you words, grammar, script, form and close-reading tools. This anthology asks a different question: what happens when several poems speak to one another across a theme? The aim is not to find a single hidden answer, but to notice how love, exile, devotion, nature and freedom change shape from poet to poet.

Eight thematic rooms • Enter poetry through emotional and philosophical questions rather than chronology alone.

Sixteen workshops • Each encounter moves from Urdu sound to literal scene, poetic turn and defensible ambiguity.

Thirty-two echo words • Small thematic clusters refresh and extend the series vocabulary.

Forty idioms • Body, time, colour, dust and silence become living actions—not dictionary entries.

One complete-ghazal laboratory • Follow recurrence and variation across several autonomous couplets.

The anthology rule • First describe what the words literally do. Then name the emotional turn. Only after that offer symbolic, mystical, biographical or political readings.

The Six-Lens Reading Method

- 1 • **Sound** • Read aloud twice. Mark repetition, pause, rhyme and the word carrying emotional pressure.
- 2 • **Scene** • Who speaks? To whom? What can a camera actually see?
- 3 • **Syntax** • Restore ordinary word order. Supply omitted pronouns, verbs or connectors cautiously.
- 4 • **Turn** • Locate the hinge: lekin, warna, phir, hi, bhi, kya—or a silent shift between lines.
- 5 • **Image** • Ask what the concrete object permits the poem to think about.
- 6 • **Multiplicity** • Write two readings supported by the language; do not confuse ambiguity with anything-goes speculation.

Classical word order: a quick rescue kit

Urdu verse may move a verb, object or qualifying phrase for metre and emphasis. Begin by locating the finite verb; then ask who performs it, what receives it, and which postposition governs each noun. Izafat binds images; vocatives interrupt grammar; a repeated radif may complete syntax only at the line ending.

Ellipsis • Poetry often omits hai, tha, main, tum or a repeated noun. Restore only what grammar requires—not everything prose would normally explain.

The Eight Thematic Rooms

01 • Love as Recognition

Love changes not merely whom the speaker sees, but how reality itself is read. عشق اور پہچان

02 • Separation and Waiting

Absence becomes a form of presence: the missing beloved reorganises time, room and memory. ہجر اور انتظار

03 • The Self and Its Masks

The poetic self is proud, wounded, theatrical, divided and capable of watching itself. خودی اور نقاب

04 • Devotion and the Unseen

Sacred language may address God, the beloved, truth or all three at once. عبادت اور غیب

05 • Journey, Exile and Home

Road, caravan and homeland convert biography into spiritual and political movement. سفر، ہجرت اور وطن

06 • Time, Mortality and Memory

The couplet compresses a lifetime: a moment can hold regret, extinction and survival through memory. وقت، موت

اور یاد

07 • Nature as Inner Weather

Rain, spring, dust and moonlight are not scenery alone; they externalise states of consciousness. فطرت اور باطنی

موسم

08 • Freedom, Justice and Hope

Modern Urdu poetry turns the inherited lexicon of chains, dawn and blood toward collective life. آزادی، انصاف اور

امید

01 • Love as Recognition

عشق اور پہچان

Love changes not merely whom the speaker sees, but how reality itself is read.

ROMAN	URDU	POETIC RANGE
ulfat	الفت	affection; intimacy
aarzu	آرزو	longing; aspiration
iqraar	اقرار	acknowledgment; avowal
inkaar	انکار	denial; refusal

Before reading • Predict two images or tensions this theme may produce. Revise the prediction after both workshops.

Workshop 01 • Meer Taqi Meer

پتا پتا بوٹا بوٹا حال ہمارا جانے ہے
جانے نہ جانے گل ہی نہ جانے باغ تو سارا جانے ہے

patta patta boota boota haal hamaara jaane hai / jaane na jaane gul hi na jaane, baagh to saara jaane hai

Plain sense • Every leaf and plant knows my condition; only the rose may not know, though the whole garden does.

Poetic turn • Knowledge is distributed across nature, while the beloved-rose remains uniquely unknowing.

Read it through six lenses

Sound • Which sound or repeated word gives the sher its emotional temperature?

Scene • Describe only what is visible or directly stated.

Syntax • Find the main verb and restore a natural prose order.

Image • Name the literal object before treating it as a symbol.

Ambiguity • Who is more alive here—the human speaker or the garden?

Your reading • Write 80–120 words and quote one or two Urdu words as evidence.

Recitation cue • Pause at the line break without closing the thought; let the second line reveal, reverse or deepen the first.

Workshop 02 • Mirza Ghalib

عشق نے غالب نکما کر دیا
ورنہ ہم بھی آدمی تھے کام کے

ishq ne Ghalib nikamma kar diya / warna hum bhi aadmi the kaam ke

Plain sense • Love made Ghalib useless; otherwise I too was once a person of use.

Poetic turn • Self-mockery protects a serious claim: love overturns society's measure of usefulness.

Read it through six lenses

Sound • Which sound or repeated word gives the sher its emotional temperature?

Scene • Describe only what is visible or directly stated.

Syntax • Find the main verb and restore a natural prose order.

Image • Name the literal object before treating it as a symbol.

Ambiguity • Is nikamma defeat, freedom, or both?

Your reading • Write 80–120 words and quote one or two Urdu words as evidence.

Recitation cue • Pause at the line break without closing the thought; let the second line reveal, reverse or deepen the first.

02 • Separation and Waiting

ہجر اور انتظار

Absence becomes a form of presence: the missing beloved reorganises time, room and memory.

ROMAN	URDU	POETIC RANGE
intezaar	انتظار	waiting
firaaq	فراق	separation
vaada	وعدہ	promise
aahat	آہٹ	faint sound of approach

Before reading • Predict two images or tensions this theme may produce. Revise the prediction after both workshops.

Workshop 03 • Momin Khan Momin

تم میرے پاس ہوتے ہو گویا
جب کوئی دوسرا نہیں ہوتا

tum mere paas hote ho goya / jab koi doosra nahin hota

Plain sense • It is as though you are beside me whenever no one else is present.

Poetic turn • Solitude produces presence; goya keeps the miracle suspended between fact and imagination.

Read it through six lenses

Sound • Which sound or repeated word gives the sher its emotional temperature?

Scene • Describe only what is visible or directly stated.

Syntax • Find the main verb and restore a natural prose order.

Image • Name the literal object before treating it as a symbol.

Ambiguity • Does the beloved arrive, or does loneliness change perception?

Your reading • Write 80–120 words and quote one or two Urdu words as evidence.

Recitation cue • Pause at the line break without closing the thought; let the second line reveal, reverse or deepen the first.

Workshop 04 • Bahadur Shah Zafar

عمر دراز مانگ کے لائے تھے چار دن
دو آرزو میں کٹ گئے دو انتظار میں

umr-e-daraaz maang ke laaye the chaar din / do aarzu mein kat gaye, do intezaar mein

Plain sense • I obtained four days of long life: two passed in longing and two in waiting.

Poetic turn • A lifetime shrinks into balanced arithmetic; desire and delay consume equal halves.

Read it through six lenses

Sound • Which sound or repeated word gives the sher its emotional temperature?

Scene • Describe only what is visible or directly stated.

Syntax • Find the main verb and restore a natural prose order.

Image • Name the literal object before treating it as a symbol.

Ambiguity • Why is the neat symmetry more painful than a dramatic lament?

Your reading • Write 80–120 words and quote one or two Urdu words as evidence.

Recitation cue • Pause at the line break without closing the thought; let the second line reveal, reverse or deepen the first.

03 • The Self and Its Masks

خودی اور نقاب

The poetic self is proud, wounded, theatrical, divided and capable of watching itself.

ROMAN	URDU	POETIC RANGE
khudi	خودی	selfhood
ana	انا	ego; I-ness
pindaar	پندار	pride; self-conceit
naqab	نقاب	mask; veil

Before reading • Predict two images or tensions this theme may produce. Revise the prediction after both workshops.

Workshop 05 • Mirza Ghalib

ہم کو معلوم ہے جنت کی حقیقت لیکن
دل کے خوش رکھنے کو غالب یہ خیال اچھا ہے

hum ko maaloom hai jannat ki haqeeqat lekin / dil ke khush rakhne ko Ghalib ye khayaal achchha hai

Plain sense • I know the reality of paradise; yet, to keep the heart happy, the idea is pleasant.

Poetic turn • The knowing mind and wishful heart coexist without either fully defeating the other.

Read it through six lenses

Sound • Which sound or repeated word gives the sher its emotional temperature?

Scene • Describe only what is visible or directly stated.

Syntax • Find the main verb and restore a natural prose order.

Image • Name the literal object before treating it as a symbol.

Ambiguity • Is the speaker sceptical, tender, arrogant, or all three?

Your reading • Write 80–120 words and quote one or two Urdu words as evidence.

Recitation cue • Pause at the line break without closing the thought; let the second line reveal, reverse or deepen the first.

Workshop 06 • Meer Taqi Meer

میر کیا سادہ ہیں بیمار ہوئے جس کے سبب
اسی عطار کے لونڈے سے دوا لیتے ہیں

Meer kya saada hain, bimaar hue jis ke sabab / usi attaar ke launde se dawa lete hain

Plain sense • How innocent Meer is: he seeks medicine from the very perfumer's boy who caused his illness.

Poetic turn • The speaker watches his own folly from outside; cure and cause become one.

Read it through six lenses

Sound • Which sound or repeated word gives the sher its emotional temperature?

Scene • Describe only what is visible or directly stated.

Syntax • Find the main verb and restore a natural prose order.

Image • Name the literal object before treating it as a symbol.

Ambiguity • What does self-ridicule allow the poet to confess safely?

Your reading • Write 80–120 words and quote one or two Urdu words as evidence.

Recitation cue • Pause at the line break without closing the thought; let the second line reveal, reverse or deepen the first.

04 • Devotion and the Unseen

عبادت اور غیب

Sacred language may address God, the beloved, truth or all three at once.

ROMAN	URDU	POETIC RANGE
ibadat	عبادت	worship
dua	دعا	prayer
ghaib	غیب	the unseen
yaqeen	یقین	certainty; faith

Before reading • Predict two images or tensions this theme may produce. Revise the prediction after both workshops.

Workshop 07 • Mirza Ghalib

نہ تھا کچھ تو خدا تھا کچھ نہ ہوتا تو خدا ہوتا

ڈبویا مجھ کو ہونے نے نہ ہوتا میں تو کیا ہوتا

na tha kuchh to khuda tha, kuchh na hota to khuda hota / duboya mujh ko hone ne, na hota main to kya hota

Plain sense • When nothing existed, God was; my very existence drowned me—had I not existed, what would I have been?

Poetic turn • Hona, ordinary being, becomes both miracle and metaphysical catastrophe.

Read it through six lenses

Sound • Which sound or repeated word gives the sher its emotional temperature?

Scene • Describe only what is visible or directly stated.

Syntax • Find the main verb and restore a natural prose order.

Image • Name the literal object before treating it as a symbol.

Ambiguity • What changes if drowning means ego rather than physical death?

Your reading • Write 80–120 words and quote one or two Urdu words as evidence.

Recitation cue • Pause at the line break without closing the thought; let the second line reveal, reverse or deepen the first.

Workshop 08 • Meer Taqi Meer

اس کے فروغِ حسن سے جھمکے ہے سب میں نور
شمعِ حرم ہو یا کہ دیا سومنات کا

us ke farogh-e-husn se jhamke hai sab mein noor / shama-e-haram ho ya ki diya Somnath ka

Plain sense • The radiance of that beauty shines in all—whether the sanctuary's candle or Somnath's lamp.

Poetic turn • Two sacred locations become equal containers of one light.

Read it through six lenses

Sound • Which sound or repeated word gives the sher its emotional temperature?

Scene • Describe only what is visible or directly stated.

Syntax • Find the main verb and restore a natural prose order.

Image • Name the literal object before treating it as a symbol.

Ambiguity • Does husn name a beloved, divine beauty, or a principle beyond both?

Your reading • Write 80–120 words and quote one or two Urdu words as evidence.

Recitation cue • Pause at the line break without closing the thought; let the second line reveal, reverse or deepen the first.

05 • Journey, Exile and Home

سفر، ہجرت اور وطن

Road, caravan and homeland convert biography into spiritual and political movement.

ROMAN	URDU	POETIC RANGE
hijrat	ہجرت	migration; exile
manzil	منزل	destination; stage
musafat	مسافت	distance; journey
wapsi	واپسی	return

Before reading • Predict two images or tensions this theme may produce. Revise the prediction after both workshops.

Workshop 09 • Allama Iqbal

ستاروں سے آگے جہاں اور بھی ہیں
ابھی عشق کے امتحاں اور بھی ہیں

sitaaron se aage jahaan aur bhi hain / abhi ishq ke imtihaan aur bhi hain

Plain sense • Beyond the stars are more worlds; more trials of love still remain.

Poetic turn • A visible frontier becomes an ethical command to continue.

Read it through six lenses

Sound • Which sound or repeated word gives the sher its emotional temperature?

Scene • Describe only what is visible or directly stated.

Syntax • Find the main verb and restore a natural prose order.

Image • Name the literal object before treating it as a symbol.

Ambiguity • Why does the poem call struggle an imtihaan rather than a road?

Your reading • Write 80–120 words and quote one or two Urdu words as evidence.

Recitation cue • Pause at the line break without closing the thought; let the second line reveal, reverse or deepen the first.

Workshop 10 • Meer Taqi Meer

چلتے ہو تو چمن کو چلیے کہتے ہیں کہ بہاراں ہے
پات ہرے ہیں پھول کھلے ہیں کم کم باد و باراں ہے

chalte ho to chaman ko chaliye, kahte hain ki bahaaraan hai / paat hare hain, phool khile hain, kam-kam baad-o-baaraan hai

Plain sense • If you are going, let us go to the garden: leaves are green, flowers open, and wind and rain arrive gently.

Poetic turn • Invitation replaces declaration; spring is assembled from small sensory evidence.

Read it through six lenses

Sound • Which sound or repeated word gives the sher its emotional temperature?

Scene • Describe only what is visible or directly stated.

Syntax • Find the main verb and restore a natural prose order.

Image • Name the literal object before treating it as a symbol.

Ambiguity • What does the repeated social softness—if, let us, they say—do to the scene?

Your reading • Write 80–120 words and quote one or two Urdu words as evidence.

Recitation cue • Pause at the line break without closing the thought; let the second line reveal, reverse or deepen the first.

06 • Time, Mortality and Memory

وقت، موت اور یاد

The couplet compresses a lifetime: a moment can hold regret, extinction and survival through memory.

ROMAN	URDU	POETIC RANGE
ajal	اجل	appointed death
maazi	ماضی	the past
faani	فانی	mortal; transient
nishaan	نشان	mark; trace

Before reading • Predict two images or tensions this theme may produce. Revise the prediction after both workshops.

Workshop 11 • Mirza Ghalib

ہوئی مدت کہ غالب مر گیا پر یاد آتا ہے
وہ ہر اک بات پر کہنا کہ یوں ہوتا تو کیا ہوتا

hui muddat ki Ghalib mar gaya par yaad aata hai / woh har ek baat par kahna ki yun hota to kya hota

Plain sense • Ghalib died long ago, yet one remembers his habit of asking of everything: what if it had happened otherwise?

Poetic turn • The poet imagines his own posthumous memory; the signature habit survives the man.

Read it through six lenses

Sound • Which sound or repeated word gives the sher its emotional temperature?

Scene • Describe only what is visible or directly stated.

Syntax • Find the main verb and restore a natural prose order.

Image • Name the literal object before treating it as a symbol.

Ambiguity • How does grammatical counterfactual become a portrait of personality?

Your reading • Write 80–120 words and quote one or two Urdu words as evidence.

Recitation cue • Pause at the line break without closing the thought; let the second line reveal, reverse or deepen the first.

Workshop 12 • Bahadur Shah Zafar

کتنا ہے بد نصیب ظفر دفن کے لیے
دو گز زمین بھی نہ ملی کوئے یار میں

kitna hai bad-naseeb Zafar, dafn ke liye / do gaz zameen bhi na mili ku-e-yaar mein

Plain sense • How unfortunate Zafar is: even two yards of earth for burial were denied in the beloved homeland's lane.

Poetic turn • The emperor's world contracts to the smallest human need: burial ground near home.

Read it through six lenses

Sound • Which sound or repeated word gives the sher its emotional temperature?

Scene • Describe only what is visible or directly stated.

Syntax • Find the main verb and restore a natural prose order.

Image • Name the literal object before treating it as a symbol.

Ambiguity • How do political exile and the ghazal's beloved-lane overlap?

Your reading • Write 80–120 words and quote one or two Urdu words as evidence.

Recitation cue • Pause at the line break without closing the thought; let the second line reveal, reverse or deepen the first.

07 • Nature as Inner Weather

فطرت اور باطنی موسم

Rain, spring, dust and moonlight are not scenery alone; they externalise states of consciousness.

ROMAN	URDU	POETIC RANGE
khizaan	غزاں	autumn; decline
bahaar	بہار	spring; flourishing
mahtaab	مہتاب	moonlight; moon
ufuq	افق	horizon

Before reading • Predict two images or tensions this theme may produce. Revise the prediction after both workshops.

Workshop 13 • Meer Taqi Meer

نازکی اس کے لب کی کیا کہیے
پنکھڑی اک گلاب کی سی ہے

naazuki us ke lab ki kya kahiye / pankhuri ek gulaab ki si hai

Plain sense • What can one say of the delicacy of those lips? They are like a rose petal.

Poetic turn • The conventional comparison is refreshed by hesitation: language first admits its insufficiency.

Read it through six lenses

Sound • Which sound or repeated word gives the sher its emotional temperature?

Scene • Describe only what is visible or directly stated.

Syntax • Find the main verb and restore a natural prose order.

Image • Name the literal object before treating it as a symbol.

Ambiguity • Why does kya kahiye matter more than the rose image?

Your reading • Write 80–120 words and quote one or two Urdu words as evidence.

Recitation cue • Pause at the line break without closing the thought; let the second line reveal, reverse or deepen the first.

Workshop 14 • Mirza Ghalib

سب کہاں کچھ لالہ و گل میں نمایاں ہو گئیں
خاک میں کیا صورتیں ہوں گی کہ پنہاں ہو گئیں

sab kahaan, kuchh laala-o-gul mein numaayaan ho gain / khaak mein kya suraten hongi ki pinhaan ho gain

Plain sense • Not all—only some forms appeared as tulip and rose; what countless forms must remain hidden in dust.

Poetic turn • Visible flowers become evidence of an immeasurable invisible abundance.

Read it through six lenses

Sound • Which sound or repeated word gives the sher its emotional temperature?

Scene • Describe only what is visible or directly stated.

Syntax • Find the main verb and restore a natural prose order.

Image • Name the literal object before treating it as a symbol.

Ambiguity • Is dust death, potential, memory, or all at once?

Your reading • Write 80–120 words and quote one or two Urdu words as evidence.

Recitation cue • Pause at the line break without closing the thought; let the second line reveal, reverse or deepen the first.

08 • Freedom, Justice and Hope

آزادی، انصاف اور امید

Modern Urdu poetry turns the inherited lexicon of chains, dawn and blood toward collective life.

ROMAN	URDU	POETIC RANGE
zanjeer	زنجیر	chain
sahar	سحر	dawn
baghawat	بغاوت	rebellion
shaoor	شعور	awareness; consciousness

Before reading • Predict two images or tensions this theme may produce. Revise the prediction after both workshops.

Workshop 15 • Allama Iqbal

خودی کو کر بلند اتنا کہ ہر تقدیر سے پہلے
خدا بندے سے خود پوچھے بتا تیری رضا کیا ہے

khudi ko kar buland itna ki har taqdeer se pahle / khuda bande se khud poochhe, bata teri raza kya hai

Plain sense • Raise the self so high that before destiny, God asks the servant: tell me, what is your will?

Poetic turn • Devotional vocabulary is used to argue for disciplined agency, not passive submission.

Read it through six lenses

Sound • Which sound or repeated word gives the sher its emotional temperature?

Scene • Describe only what is visible or directly stated.

Syntax • Find the main verb and restore a natural prose order.

Image • Name the literal object before treating it as a symbol.

Ambiguity • How is khudi different from ordinary ego here?

Your reading • Write 80–120 words and quote one or two Urdu words as evidence.

Recitation cue • Pause at the line break without closing the thought; let the second line reveal, reverse or deepen the first.

Workshop 16 • Mirza Ghalib

بس کہ دشوار ہے ہر کام کا آساں ہونا
آدمی کو بھی میسر نہیں انساں ہونا

bas ki dushwaar hai har kaam ka aasaan hona / aadmi ko bhi mayassar nahin insaan hona

Plain sense • So difficult is it for any task to become easy; even a human being does not readily attain true humanity.

Poetic turn • A wordplay between aadmi and insaan turns biological existence into an unfinished ethical task.

Read it through six lenses

Sound • Which sound or repeated word gives the sher its emotional temperature?

Scene • Describe only what is visible or directly stated.

Syntax • Find the main verb and restore a natural prose order.

Image • Name the literal object before treating it as a symbol.

Ambiguity • What qualities might insaan demand beyond simply being aadmi?

Your reading • Write 80–120 words and quote one or two Urdu words as evidence.

Recitation cue • Pause at the line break without closing the thought; let the second line reveal, reverse or deepen the first.

Forty Living Idioms of Poetic Urdu

Do not translate these word by word and stop. First see the physical gesture, then learn the conventional meaning, then ask whether the poet reactivates the literal image.

EXPRESSION	URDU	LIVING MEANING
dil lagana	دل لگانا	to become attached; also to apply oneself
dil tootna	دل ٹوٹنا	to be heartbroken
jaan dena	جان دینا	to give one's life; love intensely
jaan se guzarna	جان سے گزرنا	to risk or pass beyond life
aankh bhar aana	آنکھ بھر آنا	for the eyes to fill with tears
aankh se girna	آنکھ سے گرنا	to lose someone's esteem
nazar milana	نظر ملانا	to meet someone's gaze
nazar churana	نظر چرانا	to avoid another's gaze
saans thamna	سانس تھمنا	for the breath to stop in suspense
dam bharna	دم بھرنا	to profess allegiance; speak repeatedly of

Practice • Choose two oppositional expressions and build a two-line scene in which both occur.

Living Idioms • Continued

EXPRESSION	URDU	LIVING MEANING
rang lana	رنگ لانا	to bear fruit; produce an effect
rang udna	رنگ اڑنا	to turn pale; lose colour
parda uthna	پردہ اٹھنا	for a secret to be revealed
parda rakhna	پردہ رکھنا	to protect a secret or honour
khaak chhaanna	خاک چھاننا	to search everywhere, wandering in dust
khaak mein milna	خاک میں ملنا	to be destroyed or reduced to dust
raah dekhna	راہ دیکھنا	to wait expectantly
raah se bhatakna	راہ سے بھٹکنا	to stray from the path
baat banana	بات بنانا	to make things work; embellish a story
baat bigadna	بات بگڑنا	for matters to go wrong

Practice • Choose two oppositional expressions and build a two-line scene in which both occur.

Living Idioms • Continued

EXPRESSION	URDU	LIVING MEANING
naam roshan karna	نام روشن کرنا	to bring honour to a name
naam-o-nishaan	نام و نشان	name and trace; any surviving sign
haath malna	ہاتھ ملنا	to wring one's hands in regret
haath se jaana	ہاتھ سے جانا	to slip from one's control
sar jhukana	سر جھکانا	to bow the head
sar uthana	سر اٹھانا	to rise with dignity or resistance
aag lagana	آگ لگانا	to set aflame; provoke turmoil
aag bujhana	آگ بجھانا	to extinguish fire or conflict
zakhm hara hona	زخم ہرا ہونا	for an old wound to become fresh
marham rakhna	مرہم رکھنا	to soothe or heal

Practice • Choose two oppositional expressions and build a two-line scene in which both occur.

Living Idioms • Continued

EXPRESSION	URDU	LIVING MEANING
waqt kaatna	وقت کاٹنا	to pass time, often painfully
din phirna	دن پھرنا	for fortune to change
aas bandhna	آس بندھنا	for hope to arise
aas tootna	آس ٹوٹنا	for hope to collapse
khwaab dekhna	خواب دیکھنا	to dream; envision
khwaab bikharna	خواب بکھرنا	for dreams to scatter
chup saadhna	چپ سا دھنا	to adopt deliberate silence
lab kholna	لب کھولنا	to begin speaking
sitam dhaana	ستم ڈھانا	to inflict cruelty
zulm sehna	ظلم سہنا	to endure oppression

Practice • Choose two oppositional expressions and build a two-line scene in which both occur.

Complete-Ghazal Laboratory • Ghalib

A ghazal does not tell one continuous story, yet its couplets create a field of echoes. Read these selected shers from Hazaaron khwaahishen aisi as autonomous rooms connected by desire, difficulty, wound and self-dramatisation.

Sher 1

ہزاروں خواہشیں ایسی کہ ہر خواہش پہ دم نکلے
بہت نکلے مرے ارمان لیکن پھر بھی کم نکلے

Working sense • Thousands of desires, each worth dying for; many were fulfilled, yet still too few.

Sher 2

ڈرے کیوں میرا قاتل کیا رہے گا اس کی گردن پر
وہ خوں جو چشمِ تر سے عمر بھریوں دم بہ دم نکلے

Working sense • Why should my killer fear? What blood will remain upon his neck when it has flowed all life through tearful eyes?

Sher 3

نکلنا خلد سے آدم کا سنتے آئے ہیں لیکن
بہت بے آبرو ہو کر ترے کوچے سے ہم نکلے

Working sense • We have heard of Adam leaving paradise; but I left your lane in far greater disgrace.

Sher 4

بھرم کھل جائے ظالم تیرے قامت کی درازی کا
اگر اس طرہ پر پیچ و خم کا پیچ و خم نکلے

Working sense • The illusion of your tall stature would be exposed if the curls of that twisted tress were fully uncoiled.

Sher 5

ہوئی اس دور میں منسوب مجھ سے بادہ آشامی
پھر آیا وہ زمانہ جو جہاں میں جامِ جم نکلے

Working sense • In this age wine-drinking became associated with me; then came a time when Jamshid's world-revealing cup emerged.

Mapping the Ghazal's Echoes

Radif • nikle: each couplet must travel toward an act of emerging, leaving, flowing or being revealed.

Qaafiya family • dam, kam, dam-ba-dam, hum, kham, Jam: sound creates kinship without forcing one narrative.

Scale • The ghazal moves between breath, lifetime, Eden, the beloved's lane, a curl and a legendary cup.

Tone • Tragedy is repeatedly unsettled by wit, exaggeration and theatrical self-awareness.

Unity • Its unity is acoustic and imaginative: desire repeatedly produces an exit, disclosure or remainder.

Independent synthesis

Write 300 words answering: What keeps coming out in this ghazal—breath, blood, shame, truth, poetry, or the self? Use at least three shers and allow more than one answer.

An Eight-Week Anthology Apprenticeship

WEEK	ROOM	READING	OUTPUT
1	Love	Workshops 1–2	Compare knowledge, usefulness and surrender.
2	Separation	Workshops 3–4	Map how absence changes time.
3	Self	Workshops 5–6	Track irony and self-observation.
4	Devotion	Workshops 7–8	Defend literal and mystical readings.
5	Journey	Workshops 9–10	Separate movement from destination.
6	Mortality + nature	Workshops 11–14	Build image chains across four shers.
7	Freedom	Workshops 15–16	Distinguish agency, dignity and humanity.
8	Ghazal lab	Five-shers synthesis	Record a recitation and write 300 words.

Day 1 • Hear • Listen and mark pauses.

Day 2 • Parse • Restore prose order and resolve vocabulary.

Day 3 • See • Sketch the literal image.

Day 4 • Turn • Name the hinge between lines.

Day 5 • Interpret • Write two supported readings.

Day 6 • Recite • Record and revise emphasis.

Day 7 • Connect • Link the sher to another poem in the theme.

The Volume 7 Completion Test

ترجے سے آگے، تفہیم کی طرف

Beyond translation, toward understanding.

Scene • Can you state the literal situation before interpreting it?

Syntax • Can you find the governing verb and restore ordinary order?

Idioms • Can you recognise at least thirty expressions as units?

Turn • Can you locate what the second line changes?

Evidence • Can you support two readings with exact words?

Theme • Can you compare two poets without flattening their differences?

Whole ghazal • Can you follow radif, qaafiya and image echoes across autonomous shers?

Voice • Can you recite a sher so the syntax and emotional hinge become audible?

Series milestone • You can now approach an unfamiliar classical sher with a repeatable method, hear its architecture, recognise its cultural gestures and defend a layered reading without translating every word mechanically.

Bridge to Volume 8

The next volume can become a poet-by-poet companion: Meer's inward ruin, Ghalib's metaphysical wit, Momin's intimacy, Dagh's conversational elegance, Iqbal's selfhood, and the modern voices of social conscience—with timelines, signature vocabulary, complete-poem studies and listening pathways.